

Minkowski



Nationale Nederlanden

LEAD 4 Program Proposal

- 24th of August 2022



- Your request as we heard it

Help people care for what matters most



No matter how much the world is changing, NN will always care for what people care about most. This has been in the organization's DNA since its founding fathers started the company 175 years ago and is now even more relevant than ever before.

It comes from the ambition to be an industry leader, known for your customer engagement, talented people, and contribution to society that you want to ensure your leaders are equipped to lead NN into a better future. That they are able to do business with the future in mind, in an accessible and open way and with a people-oriented mindset that inspires and empowers others around them to do well by doing good.

“What can we do to assist leaders into being able to role model and transfer our strategy & mindset onto others?”

-Rfi NN iLead

To this end you have developed the iLEAD profile to outline the concrete and desired behavior, skills and attitudes that are expected from both managers as employees within NN.

Among the senior leaders there is a readiness and a willingness to role model and transfer the strategy and mindset to others, but the growth opportunity lies in developing the ability to step out of their comfort zone and actually doing it. The LEAD 4 program will be an accelerator for 280 senior leaders, fostering the participants' development on the iLEAD profile and a great opportunity to nurture the collective wisdom within the company by connecting people and learn together.

A successful program would specifically activate a shift in mindset and behavior towards being people-oriented change leaders instead of mostly being content focused. You would also expect a focus from the participants on 'A –' act outside in by understanding the context the organization is operating in (e.g. continuous and speedy technological developments) and 'D –' drive the change and its implications for the organization.

It is with great pleasure that we share with you our vision on how this might work in a program that would be co-created with Minkowski. and we hope to get the chance to further explore this in a call!

We support organizations and leaders to build better futures



In a world that is rapidly changing and becomes more and more unpredictable, a new approach to leadership is required. One that is focused on the possibilities that lie ahead, takes position despite uncertainty, connects with people and gives them agency to act. As the future is unknown until it arrives, there are multiple possible ‘futures’ until it does. That’s why we use the plural form.

PEOPLE NOT STRATEGIES

We believe that every organization has a responsibility and the potential to create better futures. But strategies don’t create futures....people do.

At Minkowski we help people in organizations to build better futures. The mission of our leadership programs is to give people the skills, tools and mindset to lead for better futures by shifting perspectives, mapping possibilities and acting towards it.

Based on hundreds of interviews with thought leaders, experts and scientists, we’ve identified 7 capabilities to lead for better futures in these times of perceived complexity and ambiguity. The result of this is what we call the “Futures Readiness Framework”.

Our framework prepares you for the multiplicity of futures and helps you determine which one to turn into reality. You are then prepared for whatever lies ahead.

Minkowski was one of Einstein’s teachers. Hardly anyone knows Minkowski, but everyone knows who Einstein was. This mirrors how we see our role: we are facilitators and enablers who help others build better futures. Just like Minkowski helped Einstein on his way.

Our work is customized to your futures-specific challenges and co-created with you. It involves dedicated industry experts, visionaries and facilitators chosen for their fit with your organization.





7 Capabilities to build better futures

The 7 capabilities to build better futures contain dozens of development concepts. They can be learned and developed and form the backbone of our leadership programs, focusing on where the need and growth potential is for a specific organization and its people. With co-creation in our DNA we design this together with our clients to ensure maximum impact. Each of the capabilities has 3 different levels of intervention that enable leaders to develop a new mindset, learn the skills to use this mindset with their teams, and provides them with a set of tools and challenges so they can apply this new way of seeing, thinking and acting in their daily practice.

The 7 Capabilities to build better futures are:

1. Embrace Change
2. Understand Complex Systems
3. Be Purpose Driven
4. Have a Designers Mentality
5. Design Action Strategies
6. Build a Thriving Culture
7. Stimulate Continuous Learning

1. Embrace Change

Awareness of the visible and invisible forces that drive change is key in helping others thrive in a VUCA world and deal with resistance. Get more insight into waves of change, trends, disruptions and the difference between change, transformation and transition, learn about the psychological side of change processes to and how to use oneself as an instrument for change.

2. Understand Complex Systems

Analyzing the constellation of various elements in a complex (wider eco)system and developing an awareness of patterns and stakeholders that should be involved gives you an understanding of the most important system dynamics for the change you wish to see. Gain a better understanding of systems thinking, the systemic psychodynamics in the organization and your own role as a leader and learn how to identify catalysts and triggers for change.

3. Be Purpose Driven

In a world increasingly focused on 'social responsibility', it is becoming ever more important to make purpose-driven leadership an integral part of the company's vision for the future. In addition, leaders who bring values and purpose into the organization enhance focus, cohesion, and resilience and this particularly is important in times of massive change. Learn how to unlock human energy, give direction through purpose and link personal purpose to that of the organization for lasting change.



7 Capabilities to build better futures

4. Have a Designer's Mentality

The key principle of design thinking is empathy for the people you're trying to design for. Leadership is the same thing - building empathy for the people that you're entrusted to help. It also means that you are able to deeply reflect on and manage yourself first. Learn how to deeply connect with yourself and others and build your organization with the end user in mind.

5. Design Action Strategies

Strategy is not something that is being crafted by a handful of people in the boardroom once every three years. It has become an everyday experience in which the entire organization can engage. Learn how to become a host that drives engagement through structure and alignment from bottom to top and facilitates others to define actions on the path to the future.

6. Build a Thriving Culture

A culture in which people thrive is a strong enabler to allow for all the other capabilities to exist in your organization. How do you build a thriving culture that enables others to bring their best selves to work? And how do you recognize dynamics that get in the way of a thriving culture? Learn how a thriving culture is formed, how to build trust, inclusivity, commitment and how to intervene and coach.

7. Stimulate Continuous Learning

Organizations continuously have to adapt to changing circumstances. The capability to stimulate continuous learning will prepare you best for what might come. Learning happens when you reflect on what you are doing and what is holding you back, and it happens best when you feel safe to fail and experiment. Learn how to provide both stimulus and safety to learn.

CAPABILITIES INTERVENTION	CHANGE	SYSTEMS	IMPACT	DESIGN	STRUCTURE	LEARNING	CULTURE
MINDSET (of a leader)	Drivers of Change	Systems Thinking	Purpose Driven	Design Thinking	Participatory Strategies	Continuous Learning	Generative Cultures
SKILLSET (leadership behavior)	Reading & Writing of Scenarios	Recognizing Patterns	Building Engagement & Commitment	Discovering Problems	Coaching for Wise Decisions	Experimenting to Learn	Designing Organization
TOOLSET (tools to apply)	Resolve Challenges	Align the Organization	Activate Your Team	Ideate Solutions	Monitor & Dashboard	Get The Right Things Done	Build Agency for Change

Our Future(s) Readiness Framework is based on interviews with over 150 business leaders from all over the world (e.g. Otto Scharmer, Benjamin Zander, Alexander Osterwalder, Robbert Dijkgraaf) and focusses on training the right mindset and skillset whilst providing people the right tools.



Co-created futures ready leadership programs

For us, the overall learning question in our leadership programs is: what does the future ask of me and how can I best be ready with my team for the futures? For the best value of the program, we position this questions in the context of the NN strategy and make sure that participants can apply learnings into their daily practice.

We have developed a futures thinking model for fundamental change based on 4 principles which are described below. The 7 capabilities to build better futures are an integral part of this change process, focusing on where the need and growth potential is for your organization and people.

AWAKEN TO THE FUTURE – START WITH THE END IN MIND

Our leadership programs start with the end in mind. Are you aligned on a shared vision and strategic goals for the future you want to create? And do you have the mindset, skills and behaviors to get you there?

ASSESS YOUR LIMITING BELIEFS – CHANGE YOUR MINDSET

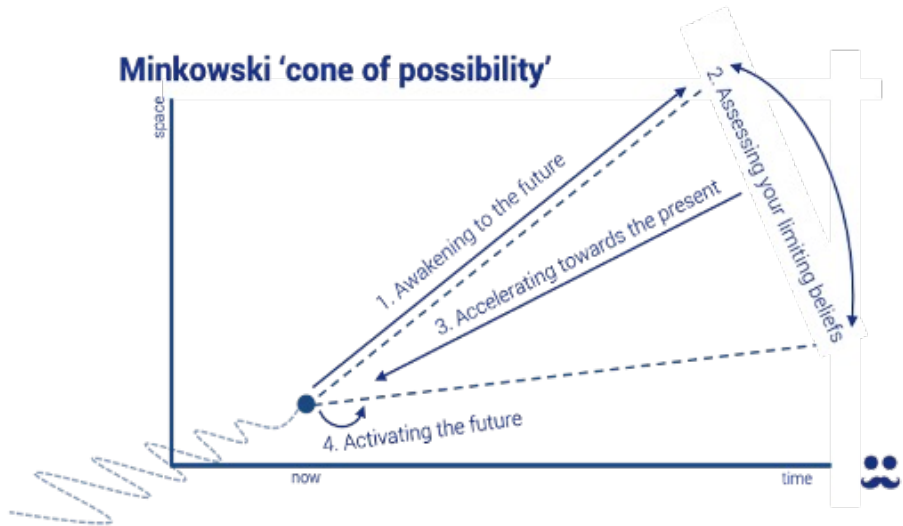
Whatever future you choose to create, is influenced by who and where you are today and where you come from. Challenge your assumptions and change perspectives. What future do you believe in and what is holding you back? What do you need to let go of to build better futures?

ACCELERATE TO THE PRESENT – DISCOVER WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

What is needed in order to get where you want to go? From the better future that you have identified we reason backwards to discover what needs to be done. How do you nurture and instill the desired end state with the people in the organization, and how do you align systems and organizational structures to lead by example?

ACTIVATE YOUR FUTURE – START ACTING

Together we make change tangible, measurable and practical. How do you build engagement around a shared vision and how do you activate the people in your organization to co-create better futures with you?



The 'Cone of Possibility' is a concept by Hermann Minkowski, mathematician for the Swiss Federal Institute of Technology in Zürich. He illustrated that a fourth dimension (time) should be added to the other three dimensions, which led to the creation of a light cone of future possibilities. We use this metaphor in our work.

- Our vision on learning: striving for an active and engaging learning environment



Embodied learning in a transitional space

EMBODIED LEARNING

We learn best by doing, Aristotle said. Therefore, we are strong believers in a combination between learning and doing. This approach is known as experiential learning: an overlap between situated cognition and extended cognition; this is an integral part of our program design.



**This learning journey is based on David A. Kolb's experiential learning cycle and ensure all learning can directly be applied in the day to day business*

TRANSITIONAL SPACE

A transitional space is the area between the external world to reality and the internal world of the participant. It is also the space between people where intimate relationships and creativity occur.

Our leadership programs provide participants with a transitional space where they can step out of their role as leaders and enter the space of learning a new capability. “Freed” from the expectations from themselves and the system around them, they feel as though they are given permission to “test and learn” new skills. They get the opportunity to practice and try out new behaviors, discuss alternative behaviors, obtain honest feedback and advice, create psychological safety, and contribute to the self-efficacy needed to turn the new learning into action.

- How might this apply to you?

LEAD 4 Program proposal

CUSTOMIZED DESIGN PHASES

There are 7 capabilities in our Futures Readiness Framework that all consist of dozens of development concepts; we will select and conceptualize the 3 most relevant capabilities with you in the co-creative design phase, in line with the iLEAD profile and growth potential of NN and its senior leaders. The program will be designed for a cohort size of 30 participants and follows our 4 design principles which we propose as follows over the course of 4 months:

PHASE 1: AWAKEN AND ASSESS (kick-off call & 3-day face to face immersion offline)

After an hour kick-off call where the cohort meets for the first time and gets clarity on the program, we start with a 3-day face to face session in Amsterdam. During the session we will immerse the participants in all 7 capabilities from a futures outside in perspective and a deep personal reflection on learning objectives around the 3 selected capabilities to lead for better futures.

We will also include external speakers that will challenge the participants on how exponential thinking will impact their business. We work with a variety of speakers a.o. Singularity University for different options of topics and speakers which we will decide collectively.

Goal: to design a personal learning journey, based on learning gaps (asses) and in light of the future (awaken).

We have a partnership with Zoku (www.livezoku.com), which is a vibrant and unique environment in the city of Amsterdam (they also have venues in Vienna, Copenhagen and Paris soon). We could host the offline sessions there.

PHASE 2: ACCELERATE (3 online deep dives of 2 X 3 hours)

We focus on 3 of the 7 capabilities in an online learning environment. Each capability deep dive will be looking at the external world as well as the internal world to allow for business acumen, leadership as well as personal development. The participants will get the opportunity to test and apply the learnings from the deep dives in their day-to-day work.

Our online sessions are always hosted with professional studio equipment to ensure a seamless experience for the participants which allows them to focus on the content and not the burdens from the tech.

Goal: to accelerate the development to lead for better futures.

PHASE 3: ACTIVATE (2-day face to face activation workshop offline)

The cohort meets in person again, this time at the HQ in The Hague for a face-to-face workshop focusing on activating all the learning in their daily practice, in their own teams and with their own business challenges. We wrap up with a celebration event. For this final phase they will be asked to come prepared with real challenges and feedback on their learning goals. We will follow up with quarterly peer-to-peer intervention calls to increase accountability and support.

Goal: to forward the learning in the day-to-day jobs by making insights tangible and holding participants accountable.





Building blocks

We use a combination of different interventions to deliver a highly engaging and practical learning experience., which we would like to highlight below.

IMMERSION SESSIONS

Each program starts with an immersion session in which we introduce, discuss and reflect on the 7 Capabilities for better futures and what that means for both NN and the individual participants. An immersion session is designed around stimulating engagement and interaction and meant to inspire and trigger personal reflection.

DEEP DIVES

After the immersion phase we start with 2 deep dive sessions of 3 hours each per capability. During the deep dives phase we take a closer look at the capabilities selected from the Futures Readiness Framework in the co-creative design phase. In the deep dives the participants will experience the transitional space in which they can learn together in a safe environment. Each deep dive ends with a challenge to try out newly gained insights, skills or tools on the job.

WORKSHOP

The Activation Workshop is meant to get really practical and plan for activation. The workshop is designed to work on real business challenges and feedback on your leadership and help you apply the acquired learning from the program their day to day work, measure their progress and be held accountable.

INTERVISION

Intervision uses the expertise and collective wisdom of a group of peers to support each other and keep each other focused on their activation plan and progress.. At the end of the program we give the participants the tools to facilitate their own intervion sessions of 2 hours that are planned quarterly in a smaller group.





A start to finish participant's experience

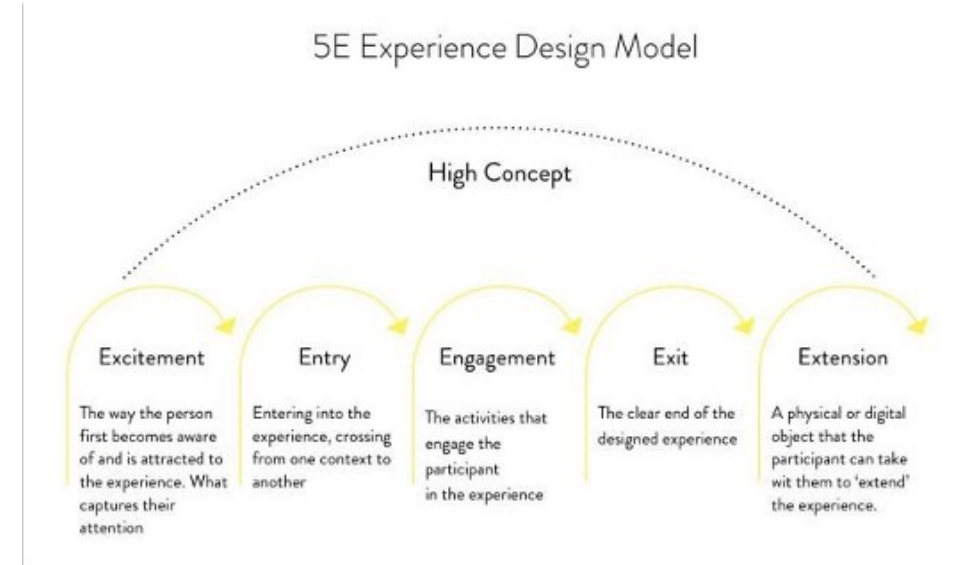
A JOURNEY STARTS BEFORE AND ENDS AFTER THE MODULES

Engaging and onboarding participants is key for the success of any (leadership) program. In particular in the online environment, it is even more important to have a clear understanding of the onboarding and engagement approach of participants. Hence, it is key to use a clear roadmap and a matching framework that aligns a team, generates collective creativity and builds on distributive leadership models.

To enable the right level of engagement of participants and to create a so-called pull effect of the program, we will design a full experience flow, spanning the entire program, using the 5E's model of experience design (first developed by Larry Keeley in 1994). Using different tools and methods like gamification, immersive (online) challenges and feedback tools, we create a unique and engaging environment for the participants which starts before the first get together and continues after the last module.

MODERATED ONLINE OFFLINE COLLABORATION

We have been designing and facilitating workshops for years. Since the arrival of COVID19, we have further optimized the design and facilitation of our hybrid and online sessions. Based on our experience and research, we have established a number of crucial design principles that we use for all online sessions to make them as engaging, energizing and interactive as offline sessions. We can also include social elements to the sessions like a Chef, a magician, yoga instructor, etc. These will add value to the sessions, but will have to be decided together and looked at based on available budget.



All of our programs are designed from a participant experience point of view, based on the 5E experience model by Kaospilot



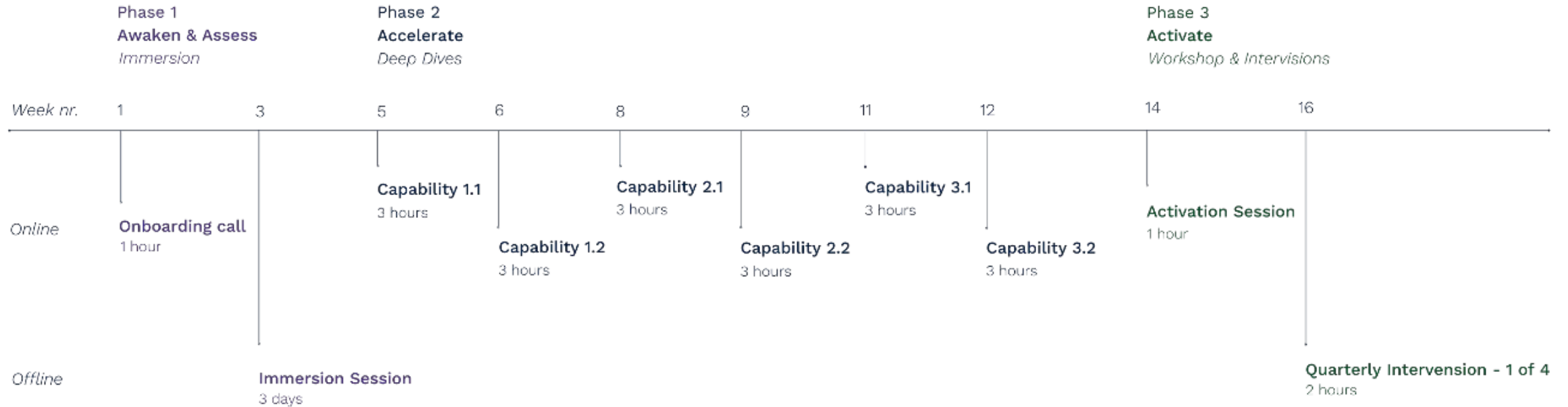
Offline pre-session experience box to create excitement



Musical experience: conducting for change



Kick-off, face to face sessions, deep dives & intervision



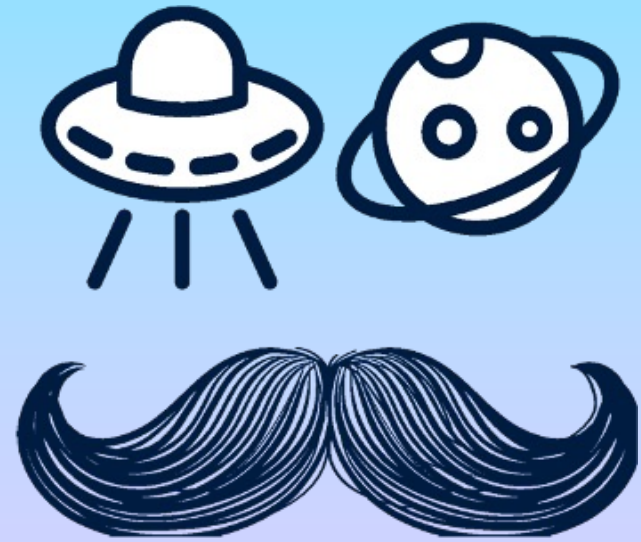
Notes:

- Each futures readiness capability will be trained in two online deep dive sessions (e.g. 1.1 and 1.2) of 3 hours each (capabilities to be decided together in design session)
- 35 participants per cohort
- Cohort runs for 4 months
- Time investment: 65 hours: kick off 1h, face to face AWAKEN & ASSESS immersion 24h, 3 X 2 ACCELERATE deep dives 18h, face to face ACTIVATE workshop 16h, assignment 6h, intervision 4X

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Budget

Breakdown of the costs





Program design & delivery

Below you will find an overview of the costs for the design and delivery of the program. These costs are including travel costs and accommodation for the facilitators / speakers (if in the Netherlands). The budget is based on cohorts of max 35 participants and is excl 21% VAT.

DESIGN, PREPARATION, ALIGNMENT & PMO (one off costs)

- Co-creative design session (2 hours) with NN team to create final design, monthly iteration / feedback sessions, detailed timetable of the module including design of participant experience journey with (communication) touchpoints & review of communications

€ 10.000,-

TOTAL DESIGN COSTS (FOR ALL COHORTS)

€ 10.000,-

DELIVERY & FACILITATION

PHASE 1

- Facilitation of online kick-off call (by 1 lead facilitator and 1 tech support)
- Facilitation of in person 3 day program (1 lead facilitator and one leadership SME)
- Use of materials and printing of models
- Venue for 3 day workshop
- Speakers (TBD)

€ 2.000,-

€ 15.000,-

€ 500,-

€ 6.000,-

€ 10.000,-

PHASE 2

- Facilitation of 6 online deep dives (3 topics, each 2 sessions)

€ 18.000,-

PHASE 3

- Facilitation of in person 2 day program (1 lead facilitator and one leadership SME)
- Use of materials and printing of models
- Program Management (2 hours per week, € 1250- per month, 4 months)
- Venue for 2 day workshop

€ 10.000,-

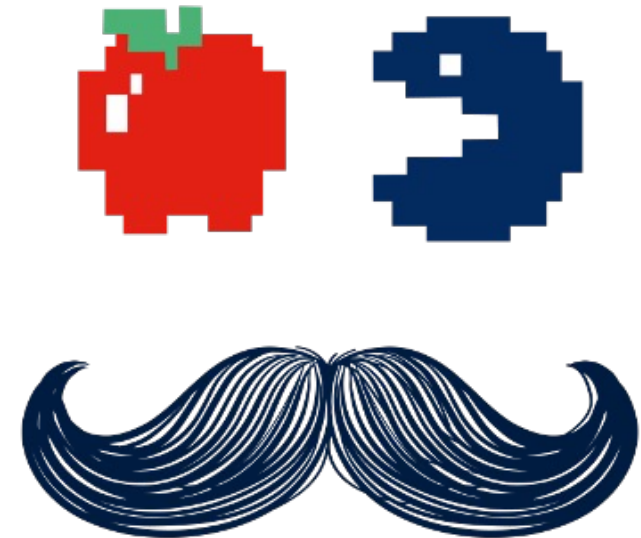
€ 500,-

€ 5.000,-

€ 4.000,-

TOTAL DELIVERY COSTS (PER COHORT)

€ 71.000,-



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Appendix

An overview of our facilitators
and field experts & some of our
work





Who we are

Since our founding in 2017, we've grown rapidly into a global specialist in applied futures with a proven track record for collaborating with organizations of all kinds. We've designed and facilitated workshops, internal processes, management retreats, brainstorming sessions, strategy deep dives and leadership programs. We are a group of highly experienced facilitators, coaches, trainers, business designers and strategists, with an extensive business experience and co-creation in our DNA.

Together, we help you map the future possibilities for your organization and create future(s) ready leaders.



Cathalijne Bol-Oudijk

Leadership
Development



Arjan Postma

Unconventional
Thinking



Charlotte van Veelen

Experience Manager



Jörgen van der Sloot

Futures Thinking



Sara Sitton

Leadership
Development



Niels Dengel

Change Agent



Kim Durieux

Creative Thinking



Alexandre Janssen

Innovation



Cato Verhaart

Brand & Communication



Herman Knevel

Intrapreneurship



Yvette Pasman

Program Facilitator



Femke Deckers

Creative Thinking



Stijn van Erp

Program Facilitator

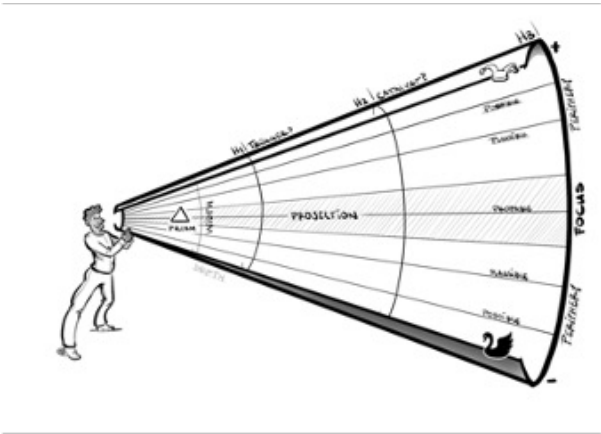


Herman Weeda

Visual Facilitator

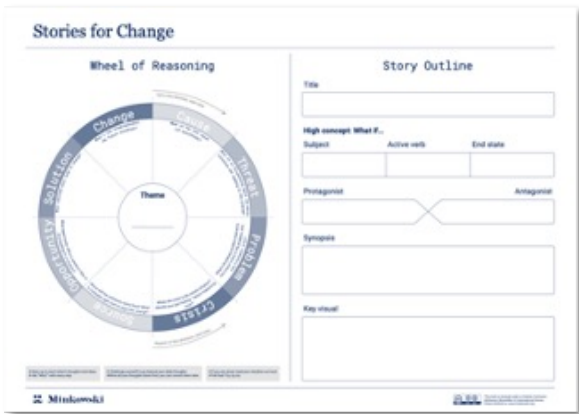


Some of our used tools



Cone of Possibilities

Take the observations you've made about the future and plot them on the canvas (see next page). First, decide whether your observation is an opportunity (positive impact on the organization) or a threat (negative impact on the organization). Then determine whether its occurrence is possible, plausible, or probable and place it on horizon 1, 2, or 3. Note that when you shift time horizons the occurrence can change from possible to plausible or even from impossible to probable.



Stories for Change

The Wheel of Reasoning can be used to understand possible underlying causes of problems or threats and be able to explore possibilities for change. It helps to build an argument that supports your vision of change and design your solution space. You start with a moonshot: what is the dream? Following the wheel, you determine what solutions will drive change to accomplish this dream, and what problems and threats you have to be overcome. This will lead to you the root cause of the problem, so that you can start to explore possibilities for change.



Some of our used tools



Leading Self

Becoming aware and understanding your own patterns, assumptions and limiting beliefs is the first step towards leading authentically and role modelling the right behaviors. The focus lies on expanding self-awareness and enhancing self-control. We use The Core Quality Quadrant to help leaders see themselves more clearly and highlight areas of strength and improvement.

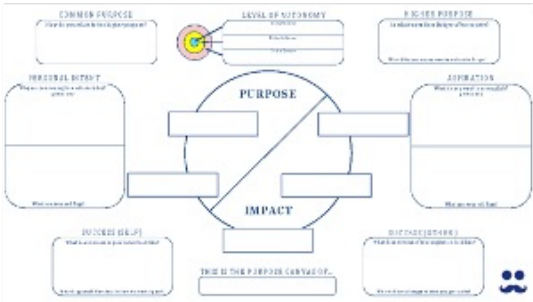
The worksheet is titled "Moonshot Thinking". It is divided into two main sections. The left section, titled "The Blueprint:", contains a diagram with three overlapping circles: a blue circle with a lightning bolt icon labeled "Big Problem", a black circle with a lightbulb icon labeled "Breakthrough Technology", and a purple circle with a gear icon labeled "Field Test". Below this diagram is a section titled "Your Moonshot blueprint:" with a large empty space for writing. The right section, titled "Self Reflection:", contains three empty rectangular boxes for writing answers to the following questions: "What is the one huge problem you want to solve?", "What old ideas could be applied to this problem?", and "What breakthrough tech could make this possible?". The Minkowski logo is in the bottom left corner, and a Creative Commons license notice is in the bottom right corner.

Moonshot Thinking

Moonshot Thinking is based on aspirations for creating a different future. This aspirational element is what ignites passion in individuals and groups; it's what engages people's hearts and minds to work together to realize their goal. It helps people to realize how you can make impact in the industry or company. By answering different questions and writing down ideas, participants craft a Massive Transformative Purpose (MTP): the higher purpose of the organization, capturing the hearts and minds of both those inside the organization, and those in their community and networks.

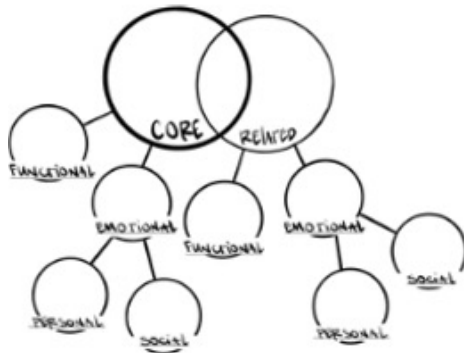


Some of our used tools



Personal purpose

Aligning personal and organizational purpose brings mutual respect, trust and a sense of belonging. The Purpose Canvas is a tool to help you identify what drives you personally and how you can connect that to the purpose of your organization and your day-to-day job. Start with determining your level of autonomy right at the top of the canvas and then work from left to right: start with yourself first and then reflect on your organization.



Outcome based solutions thinking

The outcome based thinking formula is a sentence that helps you to think from a customer perspective. Every product or service you sell should help your customers solve a problem or a 'job' that they want to fix. It should be something you help them with. By simply filling out the sentence you start thinking in benefits for the customer instead of thinking from the nice features you have created from your business perspective.



Some of our used tools

Experiment Canvas

Riskiest Assumption Which assumption do you need to test first?	Experiment Results What are the quantitative/qualitative results? Are they validated, invalidated, or inconclusive?
Hypothesis What is your customer, problem, or solution hypothesis? We believe _____ Are a need/question: doing _____	Learnings Which insights did you gain from the experiment? Did it match your hypothesis? Why (not)?
Experiment Design In what way will you test your assumption? What defines the experiment as a success? How will you measure that? How many times?	Reflect, Learn, Pivot/Iterate What do you do next? How experiment design? What are your new assumptions?

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Assumptions hunting

In the process of identifying challenges and creating potential solutions, we always make assumptions. Key in this process is to know what assumptions are being made and how to validate them. With this exercise, we have participants challenge each others assumptions, help identify them and determine what the steps could be to validate them.

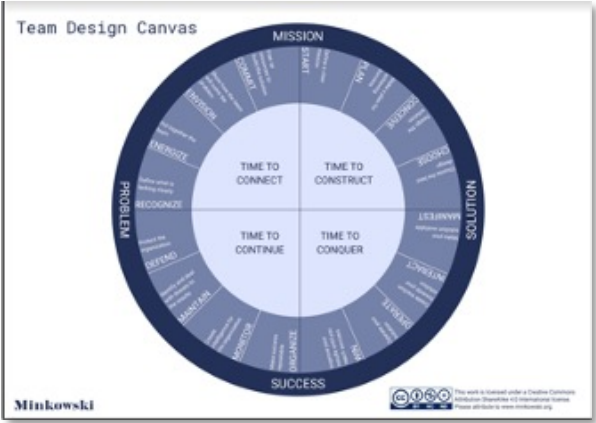
PIVOT

Pivoting

The PIVOT canvas can be used to search for pivots in your business. By exploring Perceptions, Interdependencies, Varieties, Orientations and by Tinkering with your ideas you will uncover what pivot will make the biggest impact. The PIVOT canvas is built around a challenge-based format and consists of various sub questions and challenges that you can do with your team.



Some of our used tools



Leading Others

With the Team Design Canvas we explore the required skills to lead and empower others. How to create clarity and synergy in your team? How do you recognise team dynamics that get in the way of results? How do you bring out the best in your team and inspire others around you? In this module leaders will learn how to increase their impact as a leader of a group by gaining insight in team patterns and by learning how to intervene and coach as a leader.

Our Change Statement

"We want to change _____
present state

in order to _____
desired outcome ."

Leading Change

Our Leading Change model zooms into the leadership skills that are required to lead change and help others thrive through uncertainty. We learn about the invisible forces of change (biases, patterns, beliefs, defense mechanisms), how to deal with resistance and equip you to work through them.



Next practices



Dräger – Changing Face of Leadership

March 2021 – May 2022

In co-creation with Dräger, we have created the Changing Face of Leadership (CFoL) program with the purpose to challenge 25 managing directors to unlearn outdated approaches and embrace new ways of seeing the world so that we can believe in change, think differently about the futures ahead of them, and act accordingly. In four Semesters, we dove into understanding change dynamics and complex systems to provide direction, became purpose-driven to see the world from a designers mindset, started designing strategies to build a thriving culture, and activated continuous learning within the organization.



ProRail – Creating an Innovator's Mindset

February 2021 – ongoing

ProRail's Innovation Academy wants to train all ProRail employees in having an Innovators mindset. This means people should be able to think in opportunities, understand what innovation means and how to use it, see the changes in the world and are able to apply the insights in their day to day business. Minkowski helped design a program for the ProRail innovation academy and trained the ProRail innovation team in order to be able have them run the trainings themselves going forward.



Next practices



Singularity University | Executive Program

3,5 days

Singularity's EP is an immersive leadership program for Future leaders, that aims to educate them on exponential technologies, global impact, technology and ethics, leadership and organizational change. Minkowski designs and facilitates these 3,5 day courses and helps the 30-50 participants to unlock their potential and learn how to deal with change, see opportunities to solve global and business challenges, identify future trends that will impact their business and learn how to lead and transform their organizations and start a movement,

EON – Digital Upskilling for leaders

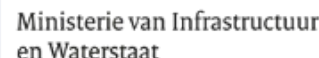
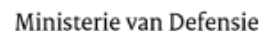
Jan 2021 – ongoing



In co-creation with SingularityU, we have designed the Digital Upskilling for Leaders program. A program that targets 1500 of the C level leadership within EON globally, and helps them to better understand the different technologies that will play a significant role for the organization going forward. This hybrid program, designed for cohorts of 80 to 100 participants, not only shows the participants about the new technologies, but actually helps them work on a MVP by applying new ways of working, in order to have them apply their learnings in their day to day business.



Some of our other clients



Minkowski

Making history by
Changing the future.



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